

too. Video lectures are available for free, with the NPTEL's ultimate goal of providing "at least one version" of each course offered at the IITs and IISc. Those preparing for the GATE exam can find preparatory material taught by professors from these institutes as well. There's no interaction with the professors and no evaluation or certification is offered either, but it's a highly commendable effort to make higher education accessible to all.

17 **Alison** (<http://dgit.in/FTAlison>)

Alison hosts standards-based certificate courses offered by a large selection of publishers, from universities like MIT and Cambridge, companies like Microsoft, Amazon and Google, and initiatives like the Open University and even NPTEL. Courses are free of cost, and if the student scores more than 80%, he/she earns a certificate. Alison even provides a way for employers to verify the authenticity of an Alison 'graduate', and to test their knowledge in the subject of their choosing. Its main source of revenue is advertising, and Alison offers courses catered towards school and college students, as well as business and industry-specific trainings for the working population. It offers more than 600 courses, with several niche, vocational trainings available. Having highly reputable publishers providing these courses lends a touch of authenticity to Alison's courseware.

18 **Tuts+** (<http://dgit.in/FTTuts>)

While most of the websites listed earlier focus on teaching you concepts in Computer Science like Algorithms and Machine Learning, Tuts+ is a site that's oriented towards designers and the creative types. On the programming front, Tuts+ hosts tutorials on Web Development (including HTML, CSS, PHP, Javascript, AJAX and Wordpress), but it also has hundreds of tutorials on Photoshop, AfterEffects, Music Recording and Production, Game Development and DIY Crafts. All these tutorials are completely free of cost. Tuts+ also hosts full-fledged courses that cost around \$25 per course, with more in-depth coverage of the courses. You'll also find dozens of resources for designers, including eBooks, vector illustrations and CSS templates.

19 **YouTube Education Channel** (<http://dgit.in/YTEducation>)

You probably spend several hours a week on YouTube anyway, catching up on episodes of SNL or watching videos of babies falling over